

R2 From Ideas to Action

Pillar	Reflection	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	35-45 minutes	Group Size	4-10
Mode	Team facilitation	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	R1 (Micro-Reflection) so participants have reflection insights to work with	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Failure to turn reflection into action, insights discussed but not implemented, repeated identification of same issues without progress

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

The gap between insight and action is neurologically real. The brain processes reflection through the default mode network (insight) and executes change through the prefrontal cortex (planning and action). These two systems do not automatically connect. An insight can be vivid and genuine in the moment of reflection but completely absent when the relevant situation arises in daily work.

Implementation intentions ("When X happens, I will do Y") bridge this gap by pre-loading the prefrontal cortex with a specific plan that activates when the trigger situation occurs. Research by Gollwitzer shows that implementation intentions roughly double the likelihood of follow-through compared to general intentions.

The second mechanism is visibility. When an action is written down, shared with a partner, and tracked, the brain's social commitment circuits engage. The action moves from private intention to social obligation, which the brain prioritises differently.

The Exercise

Phase 1: The Insight Harvest (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Look through your reflections from the past 2-3 weeks. What keeps showing up? Not just the single moments, but the patterns. What have you noticed about how you work, how you communicate, or how you handle pressure that you'd like to change? Pick one pattern. The one that, if you changed it, would make the most difference."

Each person writes down their one pattern. In a team setting, sharing is optional. The pattern is personal.

Phase 2: The Implementation Intention (10 minutes)

For each pattern, create a specific implementation intention:

FORMULA

When [specific trigger situation], I will [specific new behaviour] instead of [specific old behaviour].

Example: "When I notice I'm about to respond to an email while frustrated, I will save the draft and wait 30 minutes instead of sending immediately."

Example: "When a team member raises a problem in standup, I will ask one question before offering a solution instead of jumping to fix mode."

The three elements (trigger, new behaviour, old behaviour) must all be specific. "When something goes wrong, I'll be more patient" is not an implementation intention. It is a wish.

Phase 3: The Accountability Loop (10 minutes)

Each person shares their implementation intention with a partner (or the group, in a small team). The partner's job is simple:

- Check in once a week: "Did the trigger situation arise? Did you use the new behaviour?"
- If yes: "How did it go?"
- If no (the trigger didn't arise): "Stay ready. It will."
- If the trigger arose but they defaulted to old behaviour: "That's normal. What would you do differently next time?" No judgment, no frustration. Just iteration.

Phase 4: Close (5 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"You now have one specific behaviour change with a trigger, a plan, and an accountability partner. That's more structure than 90% of development plans ever get. The test is the next two weeks. When the trigger hits, will you remember the plan? Write your implementation intention somewhere you'll see it daily. The reminder is half the battle."

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
Implementation intentions are too vague	Push for specificity: "What exactly will you do differently? In what exact situation? Can you describe the trigger so precisely that I could recognise it if I were watching you work?" Vague intentions produce zero behaviour change.
Someone can't identify a pattern from their	Either their reflections have been too surface-level (revisit R1 with different prompts) or they're not looking for patterns yet (suggest:

reflections	"Read your last 10 reflections in a row. What word or theme appears more than twice?")
The behaviour change doesn't stick after 2 weeks	Iteration, not failure. "The first implementation intention is a hypothesis. If it didn't work, we adjust: was the trigger wrong? Was the new behaviour too complex? Was the old behaviour too automatic?" Most people need 2-3 iterations before a behaviour change sticks.

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
During the session	Implementation intentions are specific (trigger, new behaviour, old behaviour all named) People can describe their pattern honestly Accountability partnerships are formed with genuine commitment
Within 2-4 weeks	At least one person reports catching themselves at the trigger point and using the new behaviour Someone adjusts their implementation intention based on what they learned from the first attempt Accountability check-ins are actually happening
CLOVER ERA data (4-6 weeks)	Reflection scores increase Qualitative data references changing behaviour, trying something different, or catching patterns

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
R1: Micro-Reflection	R1 produces the patterns that R2 converts into action. Without R1, R2 has no raw material.	Run R1 before R2 (2+ weeks gap)
L7: Real-World Application	L7 bridges learning to work. R2 bridges reflection to behaviour. Same transfer mechanism, different input.	Complementary
V2: Failure Stories	V2's pattern recognition phase often produces the same kind of insights that R2 acts on.	Complementary
L6: Accountability in Learning	R2's accountability loop mirrors L6's learning accountability. Same pairs can serve both.	Complementary